

IT Support Policy

Version 3.2 - Effective 1 January 2026

1. Password and Account Management

Self-service password reset is available at <https://sso.internal.example.com/reset> using a registered mobile number or authenticator app.

Accounts lock automatically after 5 consecutive failed sign-in attempts. A locked account unlocks by itself after 15 minutes, or an administrator can unlock it immediately from the admin console.

Passwords must be at least 14 characters and are rotated every 180 days. Reusing a password from the previous 5 rotations is prohibited.

2. Multi-Factor Authentication

Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for every employee and contractor with access to company systems.

The approved authenticator applications are Okta Verify, Google Authenticator and Microsoft Authenticator. Hardware security keys are supported for teams that require phishing-resistant authentication.

A lost or replaced phone invalidates the old enrolment. Register the replacement device before revoking the old one to avoid losing access.

3. VPN Access

The Anchor VPN client is available for Windows, macOS, iOS and Android. The supported Windows client is version 4.2 or later.

VPN sessions time out after 12 hours of inactivity. Reconnect manually rather than leaving an idle session open.

Split tunnelling is enabled by default. Only the internal 192.168.0.0/16 range is routed through the tunnel.

4. Incident Priorities and Response Targets

A P1 incident is a complete outage of a production system for more than 10 users. P1 receives a first response within 30 minutes.

A P2 incident is a major degradation or an outage affecting fewer than 10 users. P2 receives a first response within 4 business hours.

A P3 request is everything else, including access requests and hardware faults. P3 receives a first response within 1 business day.

5. Escalation

Escalate to the platform on-call engineer after two failed resolution attempts, or when an incident has been open for more than 4 hours.

Escalate a suspected security incident to the security team immediately. Do not wait for a second confirmation, and do not attempt remediation yourself.

The on-call engineer acknowledges an escalation within 15 minutes during business hours and within 60 minutes outside them.

6. Hardware and Equipment

Laptop refresh happens every 3 years. The standard configuration is a 14-inch laptop with 16 GB of RAM and a

512 GB SSD.

Additional monitors, keyboards and pointing devices are available through the equipment catalogue without line manager approval.

A lost or stolen device must be reported to IT within 24 hours so it can be remotely wiped.